

1.0

About our Brand

The **Kingston University Town House Strategy** sets out the University's strategic ambitions focused on becoming:

The UK's leading university for Future Skills where staff and students are sought after for their skills, knowledge and ability to innovate.

This core proposition is brought to life through the Kingston University brand and is articulated in our **Vision, Mission and Values**.

The **Kingston University Brand Guidance** provides access to **core content, visual and verbal brand assets** and links to useful **material** to help you support the University and **stay 'on brand'**.

1.1

Our brand in context

A message from Professor Steven Spier, Vice-Chancellor, Kingston University London.

Everyone at Kingston University can take pride in being part of an organisation that is leading the way with a clear vision to ensure that our staff and students are sought after for their skills, knowledge and their ability to innovate.

Our brand plays a central role in helping us to communicate who we are, what we stand for and the experience we want everyone to have whether they are working here, studying here or collaborating with us.

The Kingston University brand provides a strategic framework that enables us to align every aspect of what we do in a way that is straightforward and makes sense to everyone involved with the University, including our stakeholders and collaborators.

The Brand Guidance has been created to help you to communicate who we are and what makes us distinct – quickly, efficiently and powerfully. As we implement our refreshed brand approach, you will see this reflected across our campuses, in our new website, at our events and in our University communications.

Alongside the Brand Guidance, our Values Framework has been designed as a practical tool to support and guide staff with adopting and living our values.

One of our core values is being Ambitious. This applies to how we bring our brand to life across the University. Our overall brand leadership sits with the Board and the University's Senior Leadership Team (SLT) who have endorsed this approach and share an ambition to build ever more successful partnerships here in London and worldwide.

Our brand is key to the success of our Town House Strategy, which sets out our ambitions for the University. It is vital that this is reflected in everything we communicate internally and externally and through the experience of our staff and students at Kingston University.

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Brand Guidance

V.1 March 2025



Professor Steven Spier, Vice-Chancellor, Kingston University London

Our sector-leading Future Skills approach is already making a real impact in the UK and around the world. This revolutionary model, which has been researched, piloted and is now being embedded across the University, is transforming our students' lives.

By equipping them with the essential life skills identified and most valued by business, we are preparing graduates for career success and driving economic growth.

Capitalising on our growing national and international reputation for leading the way with Future Skills, will ensure we are sought after by applicants, staff, partners and investors. In addition, increasing our brand impact will raise the profile of our research and knowledge exchange activity.

Our Brand, Communications and Public Affairs function has responsibility for oversight of the brand across the University and is responsible for brand strategy, development and implementation.

The Brand Guidance will support us to amplify and elevate our brand – and deliver our mission of enhancing students' life chances and strengthening our impact on policy and the professions to enable a sustainable future socially, economically and environmentally.

**Professor Steven Spier, Vice-Chancellor,
Kingston University London**

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Steven Spier', written in a cursive style.

1.2

How our Town House Strategy embodies our brand

The strategic direction for Kingston University is explained in our Town House Strategy, inspired by our award-winning Town House building.

The Town House is a physical expression of our vision to become ever more ambitious and inclusive. It exemplifies our approach to delivering a progressive model of education that will help new graduates and staff succeed throughout their careers. In effect, the Town House brings our values to life.

Our visionary Town House Strategy is underpinned by our expertise in Future Skills education and commitment to driving advances in research and knowledge exchange through the Knowledge Exchange and Research Institutes (KERIs).

We are moving quickly with this radical and transformative approach and are encouraged that this work is already differentiating us from other institutions across the sector.

Our sector leading Future Skills programme has received cross-party political support and has been the subject of a Westminster Hall debate. It has also been recognised by leading universities as far afield as the Republic of Korea and Singapore, who are looking at how they might work with us on applying our revolutionary approach to higher education.

Find out more on our **Town House Strategy SharePoint pages**.

“Kingston University’s Town House is a theatre for life – a warehouse of ideas. In this highly original work of architecture, quiet reading, loud performance, research and learning, can delightfully co-exist. That is no mean feat. Education must be our future – and this must be the future of education.”

Norman Foster, Baron Foster of Thames Bank and Jury Chair of RIBA Stirling Prize 2021



1.3

How our Future Skills approach aligns with our brand

At the heart of our brand is our Future Skills approach. Future Skills is the way we will prepare our students for the rapidly changing world of work. **Through the Town House Strategy we are cementing our position as the UK's leading university for Future Skills, highlighting the urgent need for the essential life skills, most valued by employers, to be embedded across higher education.**

Our campaign championing Future Skills has been backed by global businesses including Mastercard, J.P. Morgan, TikTok, Coca-Cola and John Lewis Partnership and has attracted widespread support from parliamentarians, peers and policy makers including senior government ministers.

It is essential that Future Skills is fully embedded across the University and is reflected, wherever appropriate, in our brand communications including in our website, reports, presentations, speeches, printed materials and events.

The Brand Guidance includes useful examples of how you can do this so that Kingston University's position as a leader in this area becomes a core part of our positioning.

Our Future Skills approach will ensure that our students and our staff are adaptable and ready to succeed in the rapidly changing digital-first world.



Image: Kingston University promoting Future Skills at the Global Future Education EXPO in Yeosu, South Korea 2024



Image: Kingston University preparing students for the future world of work

Through our Future Skills programme, we are ensuring all our students acquire the nine Future Skills graduate attributes key to career success: **creative problem solving, digital competency, being enterprising, having a questioning mindset, adaptability, empathy, collaboration, resilience and self-awareness.**

Find out more on **our Future Skills webpage.**

1.4

How our Values Framework brings our brand to life



Our Values Framework is designed to help us to bring our Town House Strategy to life.

Our Values play an important role in ensuring that everyone has the best possible experience at Kingston University.

Our Values direct our behaviours and help us to achieve our desired outcomes whether we are collaborating with our colleagues and students in the University, or with our partners, stakeholders, investors or visitors.

Our Values should be evident in everything we do including content, creating new assets or materials, organising an event or welcoming a visitor to the University.

Our Values are:

Ambitious
Inclusive
Innovative
Enterprising

The **Values Framework** provides a practical way to check that you are reinforcing our Values. You can use the **Values Framework** to check your approach and progress or to support you and your team.

Access the Values Framework on the Values homepage on SharePoint.